



**GLOWING MINDS
INITIATIVES**
SINCE 2020

ANNUAL REPORT

Prepared by : Shamsudeen Abdulrazak
Designed by: Abdulbasit Abdulrazak
www.glowingmindsinitiatives.org



About Us

We are a youth-led organisation committed to driving sustainable development by addressing issues around unemployment and employability. We are registered with the Corporate Affairs Commission in Nigeria and work around four thematic areas - Employability, Gender Inclusion, Climate Change and Civic Engagement.

Vision

Glowing Minds Initiatives for Human Development envisions an African Society where all Youths are employed and Self Reliant.

Mission

We are on a mission to empower Youths with requisite Knowledge and Opportunities while advocating for Policies that makes them Self - Reliant.



info@glowingmindsinitiatives.org



OUR CORE VALUES

INTEGRITY
EMPATHY
EXCELLENCE
HARD WORK
PERSONAL DEVELOPMENT

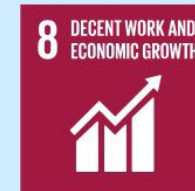
OUR THEMATIC AREAS

YOUTH EMPLOYABILITY
CIVIC ENGAGEMENT
CLIMATE CHANGE
GENDER INCLUSION

OUR APPROACH

CAPACITY BUILDING
RESEARCH
ADVOCACY
INNOVATION

OUR **7** Sustainable Development Goals FOCUS



THE GLOBAL GOALS

FOREWORD



Shamsudeen Abdulrazak

ED Glowing Minds Initiative

The Year 2024 was a fulfilling Year for us. A Year that tested our Resilience and our resolution to provide access to Skills and Opportunities to Young Persons in underserved Communities in Nigeria.

During the Year Under review we had the Opportunity to Launch three more Products in our Programs Department - The Young Climate Entrepreneurs Program, the BINCIKE project, and the Future Focus Conference.

In terms of Impact , we incubated 10 climate-friendly business solutions and formalised three of those Businesses, graduated the third cohort of our Graduate Employability Program (GEP) with 10, graduated the Second Cohort of our Student Leadership Entrepreneurship Program (SLEP) , Successfully delivered our first Future Focus Conference, bringing together over 100 persons representing Government, Private Sector , Development partners and Young People to discuss the latest trends in the Future of Work.

Our work also got a boost this Year with three Award Nominations from CSR in Action, Nigeria Youth SDG Network and Oxfam in Nigeria and Impact Investment Foundation and one Award recognition from Nigeria Youth SDG Network and Oxfam in Nigeria.

As the year 2024 comes to a close, Many Thanks to our Board Members, Team Members, Facilitators, Partners, and especially the young people who trust us with their growth journey. Your faith in our vision makes everything possible.

Looking to 2025 : We will be Launching our 2025 to 2030 Strategic Plan. With this new Strategic Plan we're expanding our Climate Entrepreneurs Program, scaling GEP and SLEP impact, Launching 3 more programs and continuing to bridge the gap between education and employment.



GMI PROGRAMMES

YOUTH EMPLOYABILITY

1. GEP

Between January and March 2024, we graduated from the Third Cohort of our Graduate Employability Program GEP at Glowing Minds Initiative. The Cohort Members went through modules on Soft Skills and Employability Skills.



No of weeks	6 Weeks
Location	Virtual

No of Cohorts	1
No of Beneficiaries	39

Training Hours	18 Hours
Gender Distribution	Male - 14 Female - 9
No of Graduate	23



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GMI PROGRAMMES

2

SLEP

Between July and August 2024, we graduated from the Second Cohort of Campus Entrepreneurs through our Students Leadership and Entrepreneurship Program SLEP at Glowing Minds Initiative. The Cohort Members went through Business Ideation , Productization and Business Marketing.

No of weeks	6 Weeks
Location	Virtual

No of Cohorts	1
No of Beneficiaries	29

Training Hours	24 Hours
Gender Distribution	Male - 2 Female - 19
No of Graduate	21



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GMI PROGRAMMES

3

YCEP

Between October and December 2024, we graduated from the Third Cohort of our Graduate Employability Program GEP at Glowing Minds Initiative. The Cohort Members went through Self Discovery, Personal Branding and Emotional Intelligence.



YOUNG CLIMATE
ENTREPRENEURSHIP
PROGRAM

No of weeks	10 Weeks
Location	Virtual

No of Cohorts	1
No of Beneficiaries	10

Training Hours	30 Hours
Gender Distribution	Male - 2 Female - 3
No of Graduate	5



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Reviews



" NAME: ISA MARIAM OYEBISI
SCHOOL: USMANU DANFODIYO UNIVERSITY SOKOTO
LEVEL: 200 LEVEL BUSINESS:

MAJDIZ VENTURES

FOR THE PAST 8 WEEKS WITH SLEP 2.0, TO BE BUSINESS ORIENTED IS AN UNDERSTATEMENT BECAUSE I REALLY GAIN A LOT FROM THE JOHARI WINDOW TO THE BUSINESS MODEL CANVAS AND FUNDING MY BUSINESS...
WOULD LIKE TO THANK ALL THE THE COORDINATOR FROM @SHAMSHUDEEN @SAKEENAH AND ALL FOR MAKING OUT THEIR TIME FOR US AND I WISH I WOULD BE ABLE TO IMPLEMENT ALL THAT I LEARN IN MY BUSINESS GROWTH. "

"NAME: JEGEDE AHMADMUBARAQ ADEIZA
SCHOOL: KOGI STATE POLYTHENIC
LEVEL: 300 LEVEL
BUSINESS: MOBILE PHONE TECHNICIAN

THE IMPACT OF SLEP 2.0 ON ME HELPS ME TO GAIN MORE EXPERIENCE ON HOW TO KEEP MY CUSTOMERS AND SERVICES TO RENDER. IT HAS BEEN OF A GREAT HELP TO ME AND I'M GLAD AND HAPPY TO BE HAPPY..
THANKS SO MUCH SLEP 2.0 AND ALL THE FACILITATORS.

I APPRECIATE ALL THE EFFORTS. "

ADARADOHUN SAMSON @ALUMNI GEP 2.0.

I WANT TO SINCERELY APPRECIATE THE EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR OF GLOWING MIND INITIATIVE FOR MAKING THIS PLATFORM AN AVENUE TO LEARN AND BE EQUIPPED FOR THE JOURNEY AHEAD.

THE LINKEDIN OPTIMIZATION CLASS HAS GIVEN INSIGHT INTO WHAT I CAN ACHIEVE WITH MY ME MORE LINKEDIN ACCOUNT. BEFORE NOW I DO LESS WITH MY LINKEDIN ACCOUNT AND HAVE VERY FEW CONNECTIONS BUT NOW I TRY AS MUCH AS POSSIBLE TO CONNECT WITH PEOPLE WITH COMMON INTERESTS AND ENGAGE MORE ON LINKEDIN.

IT WAS A PRIVILEGE TO HAVE MY LINKEDIN PROFILE REVAMPED IN THE COURSE OF THE SESSION.

ONCE AGAIN THANK YOU GLOWING MIND INITIATIVE.



Reviews



" NAME: MARAYAM IBRAHIM

SCHOOL: USMANU DAN FODIYO UNIVERSITY IN AFFILIATION TO COLLEGE OF EDUCATION MINNA, NIGER STATE.

LEVEL: 400 LEVEL

BUSINESS: MI COLLECTION

I AM GLAD TO BE PART OF SLEP 2.0 PROGRAM AS IT HAS HELPED ME ACHIEVEMENT SO MANY THINGS WHICH INCLUDE:

- HOW TO USE SOCIAL MEDIA TO PROMOTE MY BUSINESS
- HOW TO SOURCE FUNDS FOR MY BUSINESS
- HOW TO CONTROL MONEY CIRCULATION IN MY BUSINESS

THROUGH THIS INITIATIVE. I HAVE MORE KNOWLEDGE ON SEPARATING MY CAPITAL AND MY PROFIT FROM THE BUSINESS.

I ALSO UNDERSTAND HOW TO CONTROL GIVING OUT CREDIT AND ALSO TAKING NOTE OF EXPENSES AS THIS HELPS ME BETTER IN UNDERSTANDING WHAT IS GOING OUT AND COMING INTO THE BUSINESS. I WANT TO USE THIS MEDIUM TO APPRECIATE THE ORGANIZER @SHAMSUDEEN ABDULRAZAK, OUR MODERATOR @SAKEENAH, OUR WONDERFUL FACILITATORS AND THE GMI TEAM FOR TAKING OUT THEIR TIME TO SHARE THEIR EXPERIENCES WITH US. "

ADEWETAN HAFIZ ADEDOTUN @ALUMNI GEP 2.0.

I MUST SAY THE RECENTLY CONCLUDED PROGRAMME EXCEEDED MY EXPECTATIONS IN EVERY WAY. THIS PROGRAM COVERED ESSENTIAL TOPICS SUCH AS EMOTIONAL INTELLIGENCE TRAINING, BRANDING, CV REVIEW, AND LINKEDIN OPTIMIZATION, ALL OF WHICH ARE CRUCIAL FOR A SUCCESSFUL CAREER LAUNCH.

THE EMOTIONAL INTELLIGENCE TRAINING NOT ONLY HELPED ME UNDERSTAND MYSELF BETTER BUT ALSO IMPROVED MY ABILITY TO NAVIGATE RELATIONSHIPS WITH EMPATHY AND MATURITY. PROFESSIONAL LEARNING ABOUT PERSONAL BRANDING GAVE ME A FRESH PERSPECTIVE ON HOW TO PRESENT MYSELF IN THE JOB MARKET, MAKING ME FEEL MORE CONFIDENT AND MARKETABLE. THE CV REVIEW WAS A GAME-CHANGER. THE FEEDBACK I RECEIVED WAS THOROUGH AND INSIGHTFUL, HELPING ME CRAFT A MORE IMPACTFUL RESUME THAT TRULY HIGHLIGHTED MY SKILLS AND ACHIEVEMENTS. ADDITIONALLY, THE LINKEDIN OPTIMIZATION MODULE WAS INVALUABLE IN HARNESSING THE POWER OF THIS PROFESSIONAL NETWORKING PLATFORM. I LEARNED HOW TO CREATE A COMPELLING PROFILE AND LEVERAGE IT EFFECTIVELY FOR NETWORKING AND JOB SEARCHING.

OVERALL, THIS ONLINE TRAINING PROGRAM HAS BEEN A TRANSFORMATIVE EXPERIENCE FOR MY CAREER READINESS. I FEEL BETTER EQUIPPED, MORE CONFIDENT. AND WELL-PREPARED TO PURSUE MY PROFESSIONAL GOALS. I HIGHLY RECOMMEND IT TO ANY GRADUATE LOOKING TO ENHANCE THEIR EMPLOYABILITY SKILLS AND STAND OUT IN TODAY'S COMPETITIVE JOB MARKET.



AWARD RECOGNITIONS

NIGERIAN YOUTH SDGs

In Commemoration of the International Youth Day the Nigeria Youth SDG Network with Support from Oxfam in Nigeria, United Nations and Other Partners recognized our Executive Director as one of the 50 Young Change-makers driving sustainable development and making a difference in our community.

CSR-IN-ACTION NOMINATION

Our work around SDG 8 at Glowing Minds Initiatives was being recognized and we were being nominated for the Apostle Hayford Alile Humanitarian Award at 2024 The Community and Human Rights Africa Award Organised by CSR-in-Action and in Collaboration with Ford Foundation, Global Rights, Zenere Consulting and Good Citizen.



IMPACT INVESTMENT FOUNDATION

At the 6th edition of the prestigious Impact Investment Foundation Annual Dinner and Awards, we were nominated for the Innocent C. Chukwuma Award 2024 an Award Supported by Impact Investment Foundation and The Innocent C. Chukwuma Empowerment Foundation.

Shamsudeen Abdulrazak

Executive Director, Glowing Minds Initiatives for Human Development



Shamsudeen is a Social Entrepreneur and the Executive Director of Glowing Minds Initiatives for Human Development; a nonprofit dedicated to reducing unemployment and improving employability among young people, with a team passionate about making a positive impact on Employability, Climate Change, Gender Inclusion and Civic Engagement.

Shamsudeen holds a Masters of Business Administration (Humanitarian) with specialization in Social Entrepreneurship from Roxburg Institute of Social Entrepreneurship, Vaud Switzerland. A Bachelor degree in Library and Information Technology from Federal University of Technology, Minna. He is an Alumnus from LEAP Africa, Fate Foundation and a 2021 fellow of the Friedrich Ebert Stiftung Nigeria Open Minds Young Voices Network. He is 2021 Associate of Initiative for Revival and Sustainability - (IRSD).

Shamsudeen currently works on the Generation Unlimited Program of UNICEF Nigeria as a Young People's Action Team Member for Niger State where his works provided Skills and Opportunities for Undergraduates and Corp Members in Niger State. Through his work at Glowing Minds Initiatives, he has trained over 2,000 Undergraduates and Fresh Graduates on Employability Skills, Business Development and Entrepreneurship Training. Shamsudeen has extensive knowledge of Leadership, Youth Empowerment, Development, Communications, Media, Business Development and Organisational Development.





FUTURE FOCUS CONFERENCE

In a bid to ensure a Holistic Approach towards tackling Youth Unemployment, Glowing Minds Initiatives hosted the Inaugural FUTURE FOCUS CONFERENCE - a one day Convening Organised Annually by Glowing Minds Initiatives for Human Development in Collaboration with others Partners as a strategic Initiative designed to serve as a dynamic platform for key Stakeholders in the Youth Employability Sector to come together to discussion and share latest trends on the Future of Work.

The Conference brought together 12 Speakers from both Government , Private and Development Sector and over 100 participants who joined both Physically and Virtually. The event witnessed 2 Keynote Addresses and Two Panel Sessions on Tech and Gender.

CIVIC ENGAGEMENT BINCIKE

A ONE DAY COMMUNITY AWARENESS PROGRAM ON FACT CHECKING AND VIDEO VERIFICATION

On the 19th of October, 2024, we hosted 40 Members of different Community Based Organisations, Youth led Networks and Representatives of the Suleja Emirates Council for a One Day Sensitization Program on Fact Checking and Media and Information Literacy at the Suleja Town Hall, Suleja. At the end of the training Session the Participants Signed the Signature Banner to reinforce their commitment to fight fake news.

TRAINING ON FACT-CHECKING AND VIDEO VERIFICATION FOR MEDIA PRACTITIONERS.

On the 13th of November, 2024 , we hosted 6 Media Practitioners from different Media Houses in Niger State for a One Day Training on Fact Checking and Video Verification at the Americans Corner Minna, Federal University of Technology, Minna. At the end of the training Session the Participants Signed the Signature Banner to reinforce their commitment to fight fake news.



SIYASA



In March, we exhibited and pitched our civic tech tool - Siyasa - A one stop shop for Civic Tech Tools in Nigeria at the Lagos Democracy Fair organised by YIAGA and CivicHive. The event had representatives from INEC, British High Commission and Foreign Commonwealth and Development Office.

HIGHLIGHT FROM 2024 EVENTS AND GALLERY



**RESILIENCE
TECHNOLOGIES**



**FCT YOUTH
POLICY HUB**



**NIGERIA-EU
SUMMIT 2024**



**FUTURE FOCUS
CONFERENCE**

GLOWING MINDS AT NATIONAL EVENTS



UNDP MPI



NIGERIA FUTURE SUMMIT



WOMEN ENTREPRENEURS FAIR MINNA



GAIN

GLOWING MINDS AT INTERNATIONAL EVENTS



WITNESS

* In May 2024, our Executive Director - Shamsudeen Abdulrazak was Selected alongside 16 Others from West Africa as part of the inception cohort of the WITNESS Africa Fortifying Community Truth Project and was part of an intensive three-day training workshop on how to leverage new video-based strategies to fortify the truth in their communities.



MASTERCARD EDTECH CONFERENCE

* July 8 - 10th, 2024 - Our Executive Director ; Shamsudeen Abdulrazak and Visual Communications Lead; Abdulbasit Abdulrazak attended - The Mastercard Foundation EdTech Conference 2024, hosted in partnership with the Federal Government of Nigeria. The Conference gathered innovators, leaders, and young people to drive transformative change in education across Africa.



MISK GLOBAL FORUM

18th - 19th November 2024 - Our Executive Director ; Shamsudeen Abdulrazak was invited as a Speaker to the Misk Global Forum who took place at the Misk City - the first World Nonprofit City in the World in Riyadh . His Session was the Youth Policy Circle - where he Contributed to the Discussion on the Ethical Use of AI in Education along 20 Young Leaders across 17 Countries.

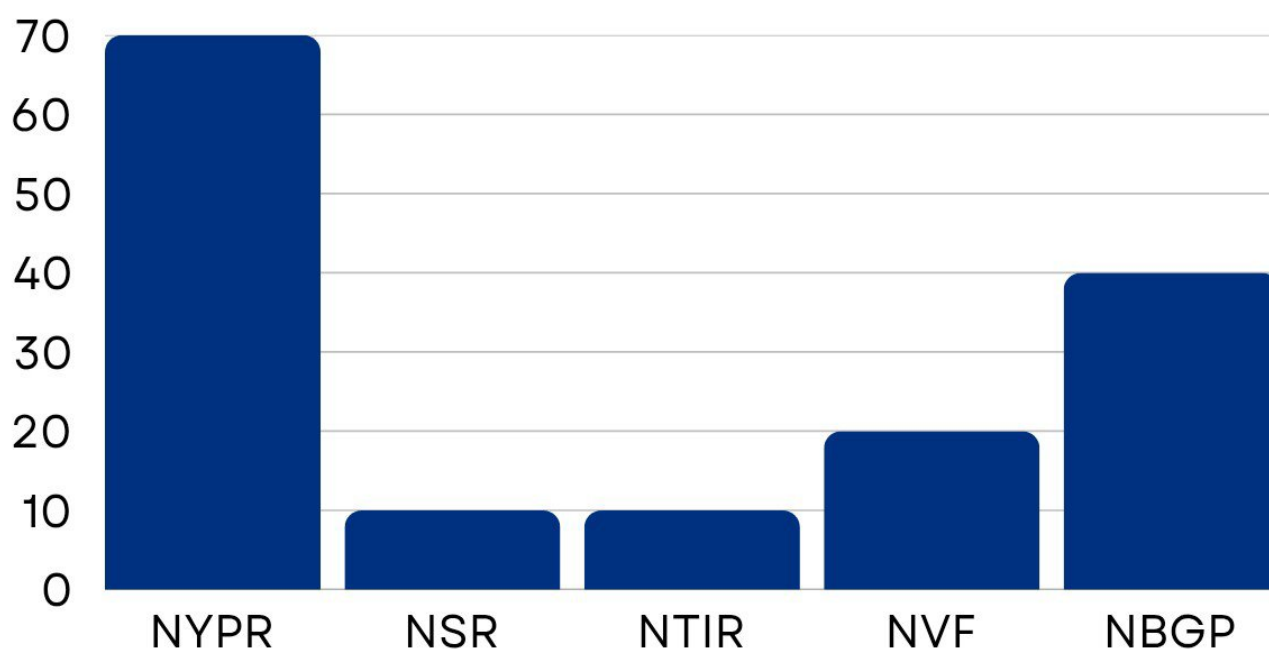
Misk Global Forum is attended by youth around the world with over 30,000 youth in attendance this year under the theme, “By Youth for Youth,” emphasizing the vital role of young leaders like yourselves in shaping the future through meaningful dialogue and impactful contributions





A YEAR IN REVIEW

IMPACT IN 2024



NYPR - No. of Young People Reached - 70

NSR - No. of State Reached - 10

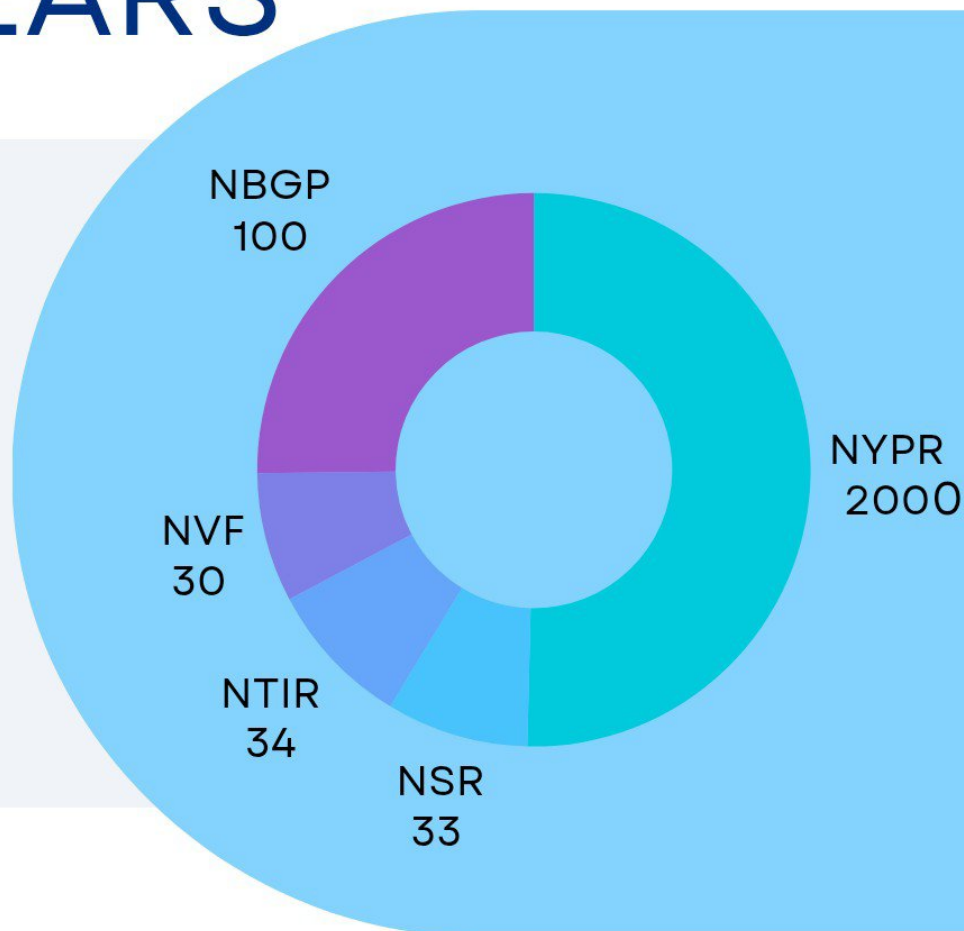
NTIR - No. of Tertiary Institutions Reached - 10

NVF - No. of Volunteer Faculty - 20

NBGP - No. of Beneficiaries graduated from our Programs - 40.



IMPACT IN FOUR YEARS



NYPR - No. of Young People Reached - 2000

NSR - No. States Reached - 33

NTIR - No. of Tertiary Institutions Reached - 34

NVF - No. of Volunteer Faculty - 30

NBGP - No. of Beneficiaries graduated from our Programs - 100



OUR BOARD



**Shamsudeen
Abdulrazak**
Executive Director



Ibrahim Jimoh
Member



Prof Abdullahi Bala
Board Chairman



Mr Lateef Bello
Member



Semirah Bello
Member



Appreciations

RESOURCE PERSONS

Chiytwo Ola
Abdulganiy Abdulqudus
Mofor Clementine Cendor
Maryam Suleiman
Janet Owusu Darko
Fatai Olayemi
Samuel Abraham
Emmanuel Ohanwe
Ibrahim Jimoh
Israel Ayomide Fehintola
Aliyu Sadiq
Ibrahim Akorede Jimoh
Okpala Emmanuel
Hamza Lateef
Hon Marwan Umar Gwamba
Barr Chimdi Nekialu
Ms Judith Bernard
Hon Charity Awujoola
Ms Treasure Success
Mr Gozie Kendrick
Ms Ojone Akor
Ms Heritage Sanmi Lawal.
Ms Claire Omua Erhuanga
Ms Adokaji Odela
Mr Fatai Olayemi

VOLUNTEERS

Amdalat Yusuf
Abdulbasit Abdulrazak
Iradatullah Yakub
Sakeenah Ibrahim
Suleiman Yahaya
Paulina Agbo
Rofiat Muhammad
Balikis Anoba
Lateefah Raimi
Yusroh Abdulraheem
Azeezat Abdulrazak
Aisha Salihu
Suleiman Salihu



SOCIAL MEDIA



REACH - 30,336
LIKES - 2,480
FOLLOWERS - 675



REACH - 10,368
LIKES - 1068
FOLLOWERS - 135



REACH - 4,596
LIKES - 132
FOLLOWERS - 530



Media Features

THE EAGLE-EYE
IDON MIKIYA
DAILY POST

Medium

PEOPLES DAILY
... putting the people first

NIGERIA
DAILY POST



THE VOICE

ANALYST
NEWS

Membership



vin
a Network of NGO

Partners



GIRLS GET EQUAL
NIGERIA



WITNESS
SEE IT FILM IT
CHANGE IT

FUTURE FOCUS
CONFERENCE



core Stream
Nigeria

Window on America
Minna



WAYS YOU CAN PARTNER WITH US

The Task of reducing unemployment in Nigeria and improving employability among young people is an herculean one. We can't do it alone without your support , we invite you to join us as :

- 1. DONORS** : We work with Donor Partners to further their Mission.
- 2. PROFESSIONALS** : We work with seasoned Professionals who want to give back through Knowledge Sharing.
- 3. PRIVATE / CORPORATE ORGANISATION** : We partner Corporate Organisations to Achieve their Corporate Social Responsibility and Improve their Environmental Sustainability and Governance Ratings.
- 4. PHILANTHROPIST** : We are Open to partnerships with philanthropists and Philanthropies who want to give back to the Society.
- 5. YOUTHS** : We work with Youths who want to develop workplace experience.
- 6. MDAs** - We partner with Ministries , Departments and Agencies to train and provide Opportunities for Young People.
- 7. GOVERNMENT** : We work with both National and Subnational Government in the Areas policy design and advocacy.

If you will like to partner with us send us email at partnership@glowingmindsinitiatives.org

You can also donate to our cause via :

Bank Name : **Zenith Bank**

Account Name : **Glowing Minds Initiatives for Human Development**

Account Number : **1225514013 (NGN)**

5061518109 (GPB)

5074954635 (USD)



CONNECT WITH US



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